

India @ 2047: Building the Foundations of a Global Economic Power

By Siraj, Director, Arete Group

India @ 2047 is an opportunity to build a more productive, resilient and globally competitive economy. India's scale, entrepreneurial strength and innovation potential provide a strong foundation; the next phase will require deeper manufacturing, stronger infrastructure, resilient supply chains and robust institutions. For business leaders, the opportunity extends beyond participating in India's growth to shaping the ecosystems, investments and enterprises that will define the India of 2047.

Infrastructure: The Architecture of India's Next Growth Cycle

Infrastructure is increasingly becoming a strategic determinant of competitiveness, rather than simply an enabler of economic activity. Industrial corridors, ports, freight networks, highways and integrated industrial nodes are changing the way capital and manufacturing move across the country. The objective is clear: reduce logistics friction, improve connectivity, shorten project timelines and make Indian industry more competitive globally. Gujarat is particularly well positioned in this transformation, with its established manufacturing base, ports, connectivity and strong culture of enterprise. The Delhi–Mumbai Industrial Corridor, along with Gujarat's network of industrial nodes, is creating new platforms for investment and distributed industrial growth. For business fraternity, the question is no longer simply where to locate a facility, but which ecosystem can provide the greatest long-term advantage. Infrastructure that connects markets is valuable; infrastructure that connects capital, capability, talent and opportunity can fundamentally change the economics of an industry. That is the direction India's infrastructure story must take.

Manufacturing: From Factory Floors to Industrial Ecosystems

Manufacturing will be central to India's ambition of becoming a global industrial power. Services have established India's position in the global economy as manufacturing can add greater economic depth, supply-chain resilience and employment at scale. But the manufacturing of tomorrow cannot be built factory by factory. Competitiveness increasingly depends on the ecosystem surrounding a plant such as reliable utilities, logistics, suppliers, skilled manpower, environmental infrastructure,

connectivity and operational certainty.

PIP at Dahej PCPIR, developed by Arete Group, reflects this approach. Spread across approximately 3,500 acres, the park is conceived as an integrated industrial ecosystem designed to enable businesses to establish and scale efficiently. Its larger significance lies in creating an environment where companies can make long-term investment decisions with confidence. The objective is not simply to provide industrial land, but to create the conditions in which businesses can focus on their core strengths – producing, innovating, competing and growing. Siraj, Director, Arete Group said When industrial infrastructure is designed around the needs of enterprise, it becomes a catalyst for investment, employment and regional economic development.

Beyond Projects: The Discipline of Institution Building

At Arete Group, we see a fundamental difference between building a project and building an institution. A project has a defined scope and completion date. An institution is measured by its relevance, resilience and ability to create value long after the original investment has been made. Institution building requires patience, disciplined capital allocation, strong governance and a willingness to think beyond immediate returns. It also requires an understanding that every asset exists within a larger ecosystem of businesses, people and communities. Siraj, Director, Arete

Group believes that this perspective shapes approach to industrial development. We do not look at land simply as an asset; we look at its potential to become a platform for enterprise. We do not measure an industrial park only by occupancy; we look at the economic activity it can generate over time. The responsibility of a builder is not only to create assets, but to create continuity. That means anticipating how industries will evolve, what businesses will require and how infrastructure can remain relevant through changing economic cycles.

Regional India: Where the Next Growth Story will be Built

Some of India's most significant opportunities will emerge from regions that already possess a strong foundation of enterprise. Vapi and South Gujarat are a powerful example. Vapi's industrial evolution has been built over decades through entrepreneurship, manufacturing expertise, skilled talent and a culture of enterprise. Today, the wider South Gujarat belt has the potential to evolve into an increasingly integrated industrial and logistics corridor, connecting established capabilities with new infrastructure and global supply chains. The next phase of growth will come not from individual cities competing with one another, but from their ability to complement each other. This is the power of regional economic density industries, suppliers, talent, infrastructure, logistics and capital reinforcing one another to create a stronger competitive proposition.

